THE EARLY YEARS TOOLKIT

Early Years Curriculum Planning

Date	
Age/Group/Room	0-2 years
Topic	All about me
Activity	Hand Printing & Sensory Paint Play

Materials Required

Non-toxic, washable paint (baby-safe)
Large sheets of paper or card
Shallow trays or plates for paint
Wipes or damp cloths
Aprons or old clothing
Soft mat or easy-clean surface

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Adaptations for Inclusion

I will provide hand-over-hand support for children who need assistance engaging with the activity
I will use a small amount of paint to avoid overwhelming children
I will offer alternative tools (e.g. sponge or brush) for children who may not want to touch paint directly
I will allow children to explore at their own pace without pressure
I will provide one-to-one support where needed to build confidence
I will ensure all materials are safe and suitable for mouthing

Learning Objectives

- [ ] Community
- [x] Wellbeing
- [ ] Learning

- [x] Communication

- [x] Identity

I will support children to explore their sense of self through mark making and hand printing
I will encourage children to explore paint using their senses
I will support children to build confidence through sensory experiences
I will model simple language to describe actions and sensations
I will respond to children's cues to build secure, trusting relationships

Development Areas

- [x] Social and Emotional

- [x] Physical

- [x] Cognitive

- [x] Language and Communication

- [x] Creative and Expressive

Social and Emotional:
I will support children to feel confident and secure as they explore paint, encouraging self-expression through shared interaction.
Physical:
I will encourage children to use their hands to press, smear, and explore paint, supporting fine and gross motor development.
Cognitive:
I will support children to explore cause and effect as they notice the marks they make with their hands.
Language and Communication:
I will model simple language to describe actions, textures, and colours, and respond to children's sounds and gestures.
Creative and Expressive:
I will encourage children to express themselves through mark making and sensory exploration.

EYLF intentional Link/Rationale

Outcome 1: Children have a strong sense of identity
I will support children to develop a sense of self through creative expression and exploration of their own actions and marks.
Outcome 3: Children have a strong sense of wellbeing
I will create a safe and supportive environment where children feel confident to explore sensory materials.
Outcome 5: Children are effective communicators
I will model simple language and respond to children's gestures and sounds during the activity.
Rationale:
I have planned this experience to support children in exploring their sense of identity through sensory and creative play. By engaging in hand printing and paint exploration, children develop confidence, early communication skills, and an awareness of their own actions.

Key Vocabulary / Educators Role

I will sit alongside children and support their exploration
I will model language by naming colours, actions, and textures
I will respond to children's cues and interactions
I will encourage children to explore paint at their own pace
I will create a calm and supportive environment
I will follow each child's interests and extend their play

Reflection

Did the child engage with the paint and materials?
Did they show curiosity or hesitation?
How did they respond to my interaction and support?
Were they reaching, touching, smearing, or exploring?
Did they show a preference for certain textures or colours?
Did they need support or reassurance during the experience?

Next Steps

I will repeat the experience to build familiarity and confidence
I will introduce different colours and textures of paint
I will encourage children to explore using other body parts (e.g. feet)
I will begin naming colours and actions more consistently
I will display children's work to support a sense of identity and belonging